

JAMES EARL CARTER JR. 1924-2024

A citizen first, he forged a striking legacy

Then-President Carter waved to admirers during a visit to New England in 1978.



JERRY KEANE

By Michael J. Bailey
GLOBE STAFF
and Curtis Wilkie
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Jimmy Carter, who rebounded from a turbulent term as president to construct a legacy as one of the world's leading human rights activists, died Sunday at his home in Plains, Ga., according to the Carter Center. The oldest living US president ever, Mr. Carter was 100.

Mr. Carter had maintained a rigorous schedule into his 90s despite significant health problems. In an unsparingly detailed news conference in 2015, he said cancer in his liver had spread to his brain. Yet he and his doctors had managed to keep the cancer at bay. Mr. Carter announced in February of 2023 that he had decided against any further medical intervention and entered home hospice care in Plains. His wife of 77 years, Rosalynn, died in

November 2023.

His presidential term was bracketed by two stunning elections: In 1976, Mr. Carter rocketed from obscurity to the White House in a few short months; four years later, he suffered the worst drubbing by an incumbent since Herbert Hoover during the depths of the Depression.

In the intervening years, his presidency was buffeted by double-digit inflation, a spiraling energy crisis, and a long and agonizing hostage ordeal after Iranian radicals seized the US Embassy in Tehran.

Yet, remarkably, the Georgia peanut farmer with little foreign policy experience would become best known for his achievements abroad, first in his presidency and then in four exceptional decades after leaving office. His emphasis on human rights eventually paid dividends in the development of democracies around the world,

'In a few days, I will lay down my official responsibilities in this office to take up once more the only title in our democracy superior to president: the title of citizen.'

JIMMY CARTER, *in* 1981

CARTER, Page A6

As deer population booms, so, too, do litany of problems

Rise in accidents, disease jeopardize areas where hunting is curtailed



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF 2021 FILES

A spike in deer population is happening across much of New England but the problem is more acute in Eastern Massachusetts.

By Scooty Nickerson
GLOBE STAFF

The voicemails often pile up in Kevin Racicot's inbox even before dawn. As an animal control officer for the town of Middleborough, he is the guy who gets called in whenever someone crashes into a deer on a town roadway.

Sometimes, the drivers are frustrated because of the damage to their cars, he said. "Sometimes, people are amazed to see deer get up and run away after they get hit."

These days, the job keeps Racicot exceptionally busy, as the deer population in the state has risen dramatically in recent years. The latest estimate puts the statewide tally at a minimum of 160,000, roughly double what it was in the 1990s, according to MassWildlife, the state agency tasked with monitoring and conserving wildlife.

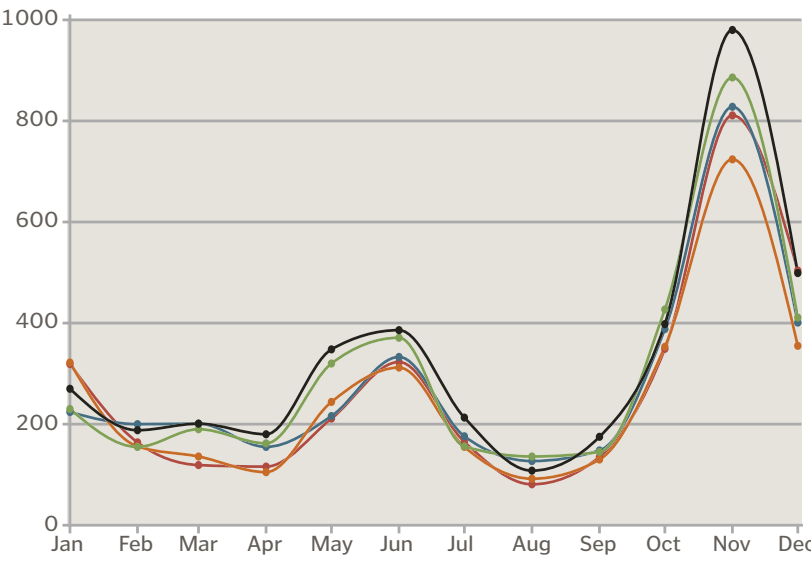
"In general, the population growth is exponential," said Martin Feehan, the state deer and moose biologist. "All of this is just adding to a bigger and bigger problem."

The spike in deer population isn't unique to Massachusetts. It's happening across much of New England. But the problem is far more acute in Eastern Massachusetts than most of New England, in part because towns there have heavily restricted hunting access. As winter descends, and

DEER, Page A10

Deer collisions spike every November and December in Massachusetts

● 2018 ● 2019 ● 2020 ● 2021 ● 2022



SOURCE: Massachusetts Department of Transportation

SCOOTY NICKERSON/GLOBE STAFF

Steward faces in-house tussle with insurer of malpractice

TRACO demands millions in premiums, investment

By Jessica Bartlett
GLOBE STAFF

Steward Health Care's in-house malpractice insurer, TRACO, is asking a bankruptcy judge to force the failed hospital company to fork over tens of millions of dollars in unpaid premiums and to pay back a huge "investment" in a Utah hospital it sold.



FOLLOW-UP

What may be most remarkable, though, is what the recent court filings don't say: The TRACO bosses now looking to recoup the missing millions are the same Steward executives responsible for the captive insurer's cash squeeze.

It's a circular blame game. At stake are tens of millions of dollars for former patients and people who were injured or wronged by the company. Hundreds of doctors who rely on TRACO for malpractice coverage could also be affected.

TRACO's newly aggressive approach is on its face perfectly rational for an entity trying to figure out how it's going to pay off millions of dollars in pending claims.

But the filings fail to mention that the three members of TRACO's board — Dr. Ralph de la Torre, Dr. Michael Callum, and Rubén José King-Shaw Jr. — were also, until recently, top Steward executives.

STEWART, Page A10

Newton case puts focus on state's self-defense laws

Shooting at Mideast rally sparks competing charges

By Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

The basic details of the case do not seem to be in dispute, and were caught on camera. Caleb Gannon, a pro-Palestinian supporter, was standing on a Newton street in September and began yelling back and forth with pro-Israel demonstrators at a small rally on the opposite corner, including Scott Hayes. Gannon suddenly dashed across the street at Hayes. The pair went to the ground, and then, after a brief scuffle in which they were surrounded by people who were involved in the rally, there was the bang of a gun.

Hayes had pulled the trigger, police say, striking Gannon in the abdomen.

Authorities have charged both men in Newton District Court. Gannon, 32, of Newton, who has since been released from the hospital, has been summoned to appear Monday on a charge of assault and battery. Hayes, 47, of Framingham, has pleaded not guilty to assault and battery with a dangerous weapon.

The case is set against the backdrop of the Israel-Hamas conflict, with protesters for each side

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The toll turned tragic, as responders declared only two survivors and 179 dead after a plane exploded trying to land at a South Korea airport. **A4.**

Waltham is in some ways at a crossroads, or, perhaps, a cross-sidewalks, on what do to about

much-loved Moody Street and about new housing. **On the Street, D1.**

A new trial has been ordered in one of the most heinous arson cases in state history: the 1984 rooming-house fire in Beverly that killed 15 and

spurred statewide safety reforms. **B1.**

The suddenly ordinary Celtics fell to the Indiana Pacers, 123-114. **C1.**

Charles Dolan died. The founder of HBO built an empire of cable and sports teams. **C10.**

In summery: slop

Monday: Rain, wind, warmth. High 54-59, low 37-42.

Tuesday: Some sun, mild. High 49-54, low 40-45.

Sunrise: 7:13. Sunset: 4:21.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C10.**